



Jetbrains gets hand-on with India

Hadi Hariri,
VP of Developer
Advocacy -
JetBrains

We have a chat with
Jetbrains about their plans
for India.

available for people to look at, browse through, vote on and comment on. The majority of JetBrains are developers, so almost everyone, including sales and marketing, knows well what we are doing, at a technical level. So it always feels like you are talking to someone at the same level as you wish to communicate.

d We've been reading quite a few articles in major publications that the Indian developer isn't at the same level as their counterparts from overseas. Do you share the same opinion?

Hariri: I would not share that opinion and I feel that opinion is very prejudiced against the Indian developer community. It's based on misconceptions. Everyone knows that there are a lot of consulting and software development companies abroad that have software houses in India that tell them what they should and shouldn't do. If our interpretation of that is "Indian developers don't have creativity" then it's absurd and nonsense. Because that same concept would apply to any country. If you are hiring a company to do exactly what you're asking them to do then that's stereotyping and that's wrong. I have met amazingly creative developers from India and all of the companies that we know in the Silicon Valley including Google and Facebook have tonnes of Indian developers who have migrated there. So I definitely don't share that opinion.

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d I believe this is the first time folks from JetBrains have come down to India, so why India and why now?

Hariri: So we've seen growth in India over the years and there's a lot of technology and there's a lot of development going on in India for many many years. And we've started to see an increase in not only demand from our customers to come to India and be more involved in India but also from the developer communities in terms of tooling and other aspects. So for some time we've had growth in sales from India and we've wanted to come down to India for some years. This year we've started with a more hands-on activity in India.

d With any open-source project the community plays a huge role in the development of the project in its lifetime. What would you say is unique about the JetBrains community?

Hariri: There are a couple of factors here. First of all, we believe in reaching out to where the community is rather than driving the community to where we are. So we do not force people into our support channel or our services. We reach out to StackOverflow, we provide support on Twitter and we go to forums where the developers are. We have a very open aspect around what we do. The majority, if not every, product released by JetBrains publicly has a completely open issue tracker. So all bugs and features and everything that we are bringing into that product are essentially logged and

d Could you shed more light on your student outreach programme? Most software companies tend to give student licenses to only those colleges which issue .edu email IDs which isn't the case in India. What's your approach?

Hariri: Essentially what we provide is licenses to any officially recognised institution. If it's a university in India, whether a public or private institution, as long as they can demonstrate that their goal is teaching students then they qualify for free licenses. So there isn't any rigid rule, we base it very much on the trust model. Any company that is providing commercial training wouldn't qualify and we have other programmes in place for such companies. For students, there isn't any hard requirements, it comes down to proving you are a student and you are enrolled in an official institution. **d**